Glossary

discontent (adj.) - dissatisfaction with one's circumstances

amiss (adj.) - not quite right

growl (v) - make a low guttural sound in the throat

grumble (n) – a complaint about something in a bad-tempered way

gloomy (adj.) - sad or unhappy or depressing

queerest (adj.) – the strangest or the most unusual

acknowledge (v) - accept or admit the existence or truth of

terrible (adj.) - extremely bad or serious

wandering (v) - walking or moving in a leisurely or aimless way

A. Read the following lines from the poem and answer the questions given below.

1. *There's a family nobody likes to meet;*
   They live, it is said, on Complaining Street

   a. Where does the family live?

   b. Why do you think the street is named as 'Complaining Street'?

2. *They growl at that and they growl at this;*
   Whatever comes, there is something amiss;

   a. What does the word 'growl' mean here?

   b. Why do they find everything amiss?

3. *Nothing goes right with the folks you meet*
   Down on that gloomy Complaining Street.

   a. What is the opinion about the folks you meet down the street?

   b. What does the word 'gloomy' mean here?

4. *The worst thing is that if anyone stays*
   Among them too long, he will learn their ways;

   a. What is the worst thing that can happen if anyone stays with them?

   b. What are the ways of the Grumble family?

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